

XingTu + Amulet

Traffic & Economics v3.0

Updated with Realistic Marketing Costs

June 21, 2026

Previous model (v2.0): \$0 mktg -> \$4,756/mo net, 6.3 mo break-even at 50k visits

Question: Where does 50k traffic come from? What does it cost?

New finding: No paid channel is profitable for \$25 amulets

SEO is NOT optional. SEO IS the business model.

Paid acquisition is structurally unprofitable for \$25 physical product.

1. Traffic Channels — Reality Check

Channel	CPA/visit	50k/mo?	Time	Risk
SEO Organic	\$0 (time)	YES 30k-100k	6-18 mo	Low
TikTok Organic	\$0 (time)	MAYBE 10k-30k	3-12 mo	Med
Telegram Ads SG/MY	\$0.25-0.60	NO (inventory)	1-2 wk	Low
Google Search Ads	\$0.80-1.50	NO (volume)	Immediate	Med
TikTok/IG Paid	\$0.50-1.20	NO (cost)	Immediate	High
Influencer	\$0.10-0.50	MAYBE at \$5k+	2-4 wk	Med
ASO	\$0 (time)	NO (small)	3-6 mo	Low

SEO golden keyword: "Chinese name generator"

8k-15k monthly searches. ZERO competitors with ratings. Low SEO difficulty. Total addressable search: 160k-300k/mo across all related keywords.

2. Updated Financial Model

3 scenarios with realistic marketing costs

	Pessimistic	Moderate	Optimistic	Target
Traffic/mo	5,000	15,000	50,000	50,000
Marketing/mo	\$0	\$500	\$2,000	\$500
Orders/mo	2.5	27	263	263
Revenue/mo	\$62	\$675	\$6,562	\$6,562
NET/mo	\$30	-\$24	\$2,756	\$4,256
Year 1 net	\$365	-\$285	\$33,071	\$51,071
Break-even	NEVER	NEVER	10.9 mo	7.0 mo

Moderate scenario (15k visits + \$500 mktg) goes **NEGATIVE**. Marketing spend at moderate traffic destroys the business.

Target scenario (50k visits + \$500 mktg) = \$4,256/mo net, 7.0 mo break-even. Viable but requires SEO discipline.

Break-even sensitivity (with \$2k/mo marketing at 50k visits)

Monthly net after mktg	Months to \$30k break-even	Verdict
\$2,000	15.0	Marginal
\$2,756 (Optimistic+\$2k)	10.9	Acceptable
\$4,256 (Target: \$500 mktg)	7.0	GOOD
\$5,000	6.0	EXCELLENT

3. Traffic Unit Economics — Per Buyer Cost

Channel	Visits to 1 buyer	Cost	Margin	ROI
SEO Organic	2k-5k visits = 1 buyer	\$0	\$18.18	INFINITE
TikTok Organic	2k-5k views = 1 buyer	\$0	\$18.18	INFINITE
Telegram Ads	500 visits = \$125-300	\$125-300	\$18.18	NEGATIVE
Google Ads	500 visits = \$400-750	\$400-750	\$18.18	NEGATIVE
TikTok/IG Paid	500 visits = \$250-600	\$250-600	\$18.18	NEGATIVE

Hard truth: EVERY paid channel loses money per customer at current \$25 amulet price. Organic is NOT optional.

What would make paid acquisition work?

- A: Premium tier (\$50-75 amulet) — better packaging, higher perceived value
- B: Subscription add-on (\$3-5/mo for daily BaZi) — recurring revenue offsets CPA
- C: Higher conversion (10% amulet view to 25%, 5% purchase to 10%)
- D: Wholesale/affiliate — sell through existing Feng Shui stores

4. Probe Test Design (\$300 Budget)

Test: Google Search Ads on "chinese name generator" keyword

Parameter	Value
Budget	\$300 (\$10/day x 30 days)
Keyword	chinese name generator (exact + phrase)
Landing page	The name generator tool itself
Target geo	US + UK + Canada + Australia + Singapore
Time to result	3-7 days for statistical significance

Go / No-Go Criteria

Metric	GO	CONDITIONAL	NO-GO
CPC	<\$1.50	\$1.50-3.00	>\$3.00
Name completion	>50%	30-50%	<30%
Amulet view rate	>8%	3-8%	<3%
Cost per name gen	<\$3.00	\$3.00-6.00	>\$6.00
DECISION	Proceed to build	Pivot to SEO only	Reconsider

If GO: \$200 more on Telegram Ads (SG/MY) + \$100 on micro-influencer seeding. Total probe: \$600 for 3-channel validation.

5. \$30k Seed Allocation (Recommended)

Item	Amount	Why
MVP Build	\$10,000	Name gen + BaZi + amulet flow + tracker
First inventory	\$5,000	500-1000 units (\$2.5k) + packaging + samples
SEO Content	\$5,000	50+ articles at \$50-100 each — THE growth engine
Channel probe tests	\$3,000	Google Ads \$1k + TG Ads \$1k + Influencers \$1k
Legal + domain + misc	\$2,000	Privacy policy, ToS, domain, incorporation
Working capital	\$5,000	Buffer for operations

Updated Verdict v3.0

Conditional Go — SEO-First Mandate

Previous (v2.0): \$0 mktg -> \$4,756/mo, 6.3 mo break-even at 50k visits

Updated (v3.0): \$500 mktg -> \$4,256/mo net, 7.0 mo break-even at 50k visits

With \$2k mktg: \$2,756/mo net, 10.9 mo break-even

Worst case (15k visits + mktg): -\$24/mo — NEVER break even

SEO is not optional. SEO IS the business model. Build the name generator as an SEO asset first.

Don't spend \$30k on paid ads. Spend it on product + content assets that compound.